

- **Increase the severity of injuries in the event of a crash.**
The force of impact in a crash increases with speed, leading to more severe injuries or fatalities.

SPEED LIMITS

Speed limits indicate the maximum speed legal under ideal conditions. Washington law also requires you to drive at speeds that are safe for current road conditions. This means reducing your speed when conditions are poor. You can drive below the speed limit, but exceeding it is illegal.

You're responsible for always driving at a safe speed, regardless of the posted limit.

ADJUSTING SPEED FOR CONDITIONS

Speeding is a dangerous and unnecessary risk. Arriving late is better than not arriving at all. Reduce your speed in conditions like the following:

- Sharp curves or hills where visibility is limited
- Slippery roads due to rain, snow, or ice
- Areas with pedestrians, children, cyclists, or animals
- Shopping centers, parking lots, and areas with heavy foot traffic
- Heavy traffic congestion
- Narrow bridges and tunnels
- Residential areas

